TidyTuesday Week 43

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Tuesday 20th October, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly ritual where we feed the slot machine of American economic data two randomly chosen series and pray to the gods of statistics that something, anything, happens. This week was a short one – just two days of pairings – and I regret to inform you that the universe remained stubbornly, magnificently indifferent to our efforts. But let's walk through the wreckage together, because that's what we do here.

Monday the 19th gave us a true clash of titans: "Weekday-Basis Seasonal Factors: Light Truck Production" versus "Export Price Index for Nonferrous Metal (Except Aluminum) Production and Processing." I was on the edge of my seat. And then the numbers came in with a p-value of 0.93 and an R-squared of 0.0000349, which is a very fancy way of saying these two series have never met, will never meet, and would not recognize each other at a party. The raw regression found nothing. The detrended regression found even more nothing, if that's possible. For once, both versions agree completely: there is no relationship here, there was never going to be a relationship here, and the seasonal quirks of light truck assembly lines have absolutely no opinion on the export price of non-aluminum metals. Refreshing, honestly. No mirage to debunk because there was no oasis to begin with.

Tuesday the 20th is where it got spicy, and by spicy I mean textbook. We paired the Import Price Index for Latin American Agriculture, Forestry, Fishing and Hunting against "Checkable Deposits and Currency Held by the 50th to 90th Wealth Percentiles" – a series so dead it literally has "DISCONTINUED" in the title, which is the data equivalent of regressing on a ghost. The raw regression lit up like a Christmas tree: p-value of 0.0006, R-squared of 0.27, the whole dramatic production. For one brief, shining moment, you might have believed that how much cash the upper-middle class keeps in their checking accounts is deeply entwined with the price of imported Latin American produce. Then we detrended it, and the relationship evaporated so fast it left a little puff of smoke – p-value rocketed up to 0.86 and the R-squared cratered to basically zero. This, dear reader, is the exact trend-mirage this project exists to mock: two series that happened to drift the same way over the years, holding hands only because time was dragging them both along in the same direction.

So the official tally this week is: one pair that found nothing and admitted it, and one pair that pretended to find something and immediately recanted under mild questioning. No genuine relationships survived both regressions, which is roughly what you should expect, because – and I cannot stress this enough – we are pulling random pairs of series out of a giant database and shoving them into a straight line. There is no theory here, no causal story, no hypothesis beyond

"huh, I wonder." Spurious correlation is not a bug in this project; it is the entire personality of this project. Tune in next week, when we will once again confuse coincidence for meaning and then bravely talk ourselves out of it.

2 Date: 2026-10-19

Series ID: G17MVSFWLTRUCKS
This series is titled Weekday-Basis Seasonal Factors: Light Truck Production and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Seasonal Factor and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2027-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: IY3314
This series is titled Export Price Index (NAICS): Nonferrous Metal (Except Aluminum) Production and Processing and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 2005=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2005-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IY3314	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.004
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.008633
Date:	Mon, 19 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.926
Time:	17:51:42	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1453.3
No. Observations:	249	**AIC:**	2911.
Df Residuals:	247	**BIC:**	2918.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	224.0975	50.852	4.407	0.000	123.938	324.257
value_fred_G17MVSFWLTRUCKS	-0.0470	0.506	-0.093	0.926	-1.044	0.950

Omnibus:	96.948	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.011
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	270.714
Skew:	1.770	**Prob(JB):**	1.64e-59
Kurtosis:	6.683	**Cond. No.**	969.

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

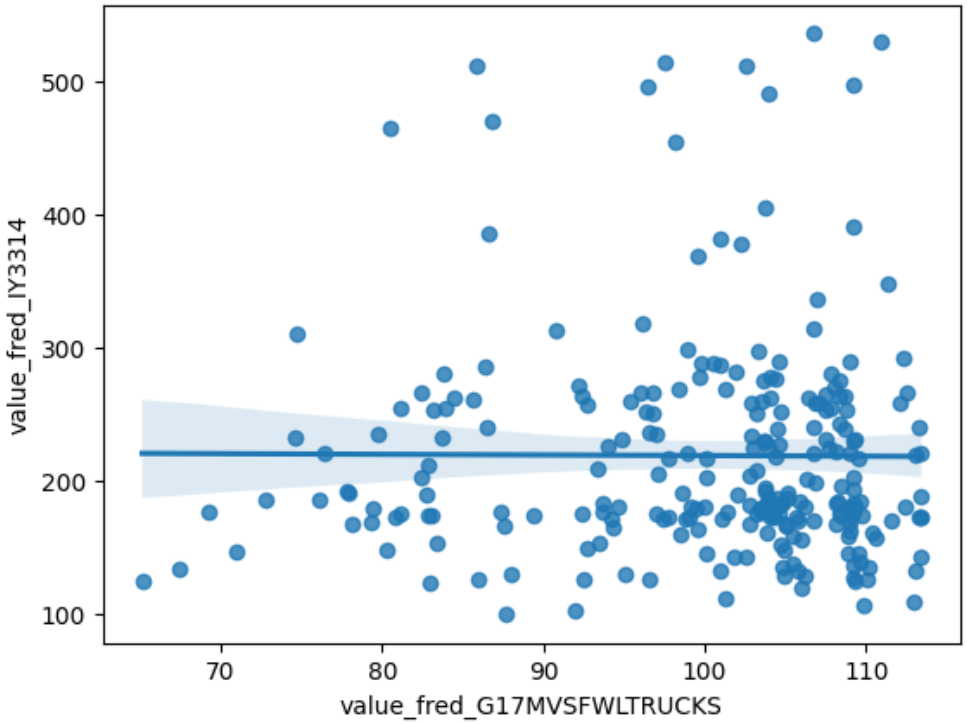


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-19

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IY3314_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.004
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.02068
Date:	Mon, 19 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.886
Time:	17:51:42	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1346.8
No. Observations:	249	**AIC:**	2698.
Df Residuals:	247	**BIC:**	2705.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-6.754e-12	3.439	-1.96e-12	1.000	-6.774	6.774
value_fred_G17MVSFWLTRUCKS_detrended	0.0475	0.330	0.144	0.886	-0.603	0.697

Omnibus:	75.189	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.024
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	174.874
Skew:	1.427	**Prob(JB):**	1.06e-38
Kurtosis:	5.952	**Cond. No.**	10.4

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

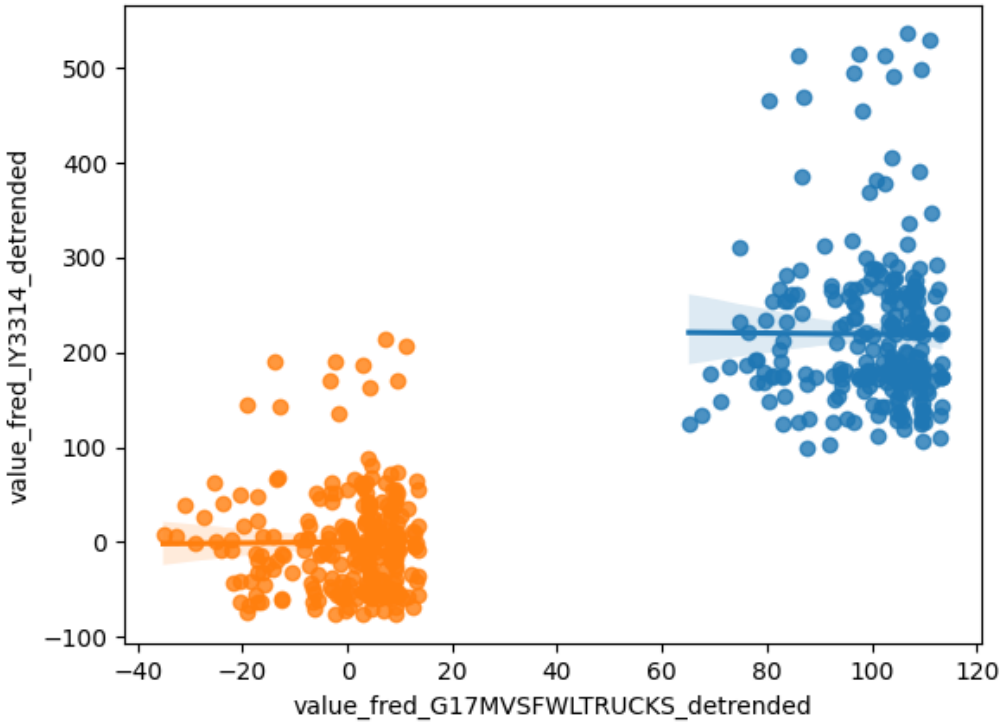


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-19

3 Date: 2026-10-20

Series ID: COLATZ11
This series is titled Import Price Index by Origin (NAICS): Agriculture, Forestry, Fishing and Hunting for Latin America and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jun 2012=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2012-06-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: WFRBLN40059
This series is titled Checkable Deposits and Currency Held by the 50th to 90th Wealth Percentiles (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1989-07-01 and the observation end date is 2022-04-01.The popularity of this series is 2.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_WFRBLN40059	**R-squared:**	0.267
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.248
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	13.87
Date:	Tue, 20 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.000635
Time:	15:55:02	**Log-Likelihood:**	-553.28
No. Observations:	40	**AIC:**	1111.
Df Residuals:	38	**BIC:**	1114.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-1.261e+06	4.72e+05	-2.672	0.011	-2.22e+06	-3.06e+05
value_fred_COLATZ11	1.62e+04	4349.040	3.724	0.001	7390.953	2.5e+04

Omnibus:	8.566	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.269
Prob(Omnibus):	0.014	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	7.873
Skew:	1.067	**Prob(JB):**	0.0195
Kurtosis:	3.413	**Cond. No.**	1.28e+03

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 1.28e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

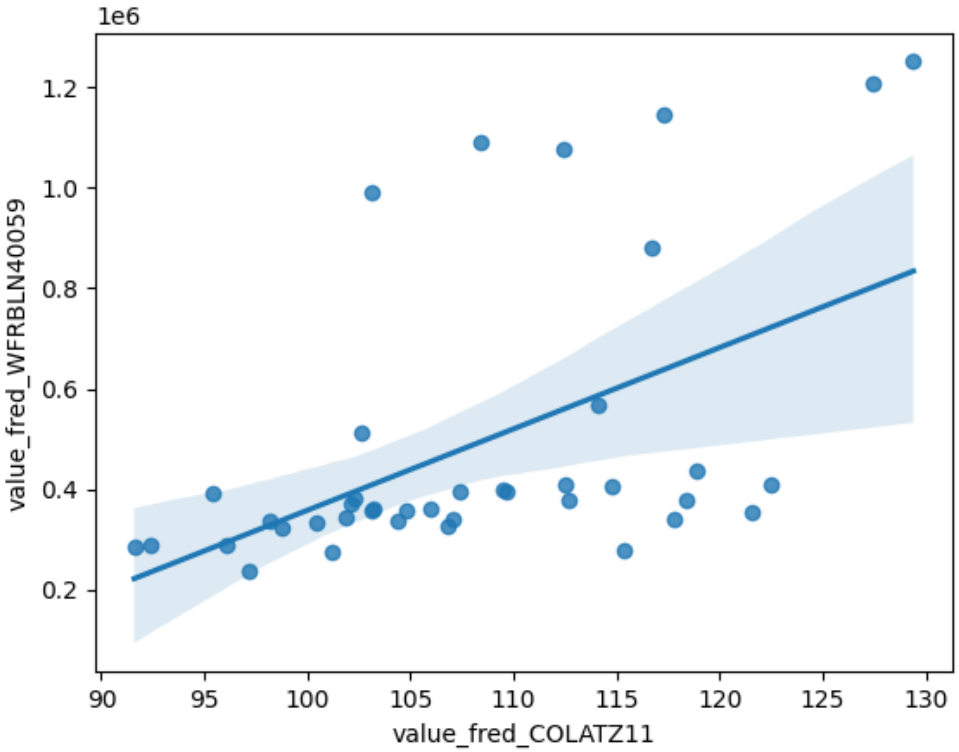


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-20

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_WFRBLN40059_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.001
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.025
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.03202
Date:	Tue, 20 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.859
Time:	15:55:02	**Log-Likelihood:**	-543.18
No. Observations:	40	**AIC:**	1090.
Df Residuals:	38	**BIC:**	1094.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-5.959e-08	3.1e+04	-1.92e-12	1.000	-6.28e+04	6.28e+04
value_fred_COLATZ11_detrended	-859.3401	4802.520	-0.179	0.859	-1.06e+04	8862.854

Omnibus:	0.421	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.106
Prob(Omnibus):	0.810	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.579
Skew:	0.150	**Prob(JB):**	0.749
Kurtosis:	2.493	**Cond. No.**	6.46

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

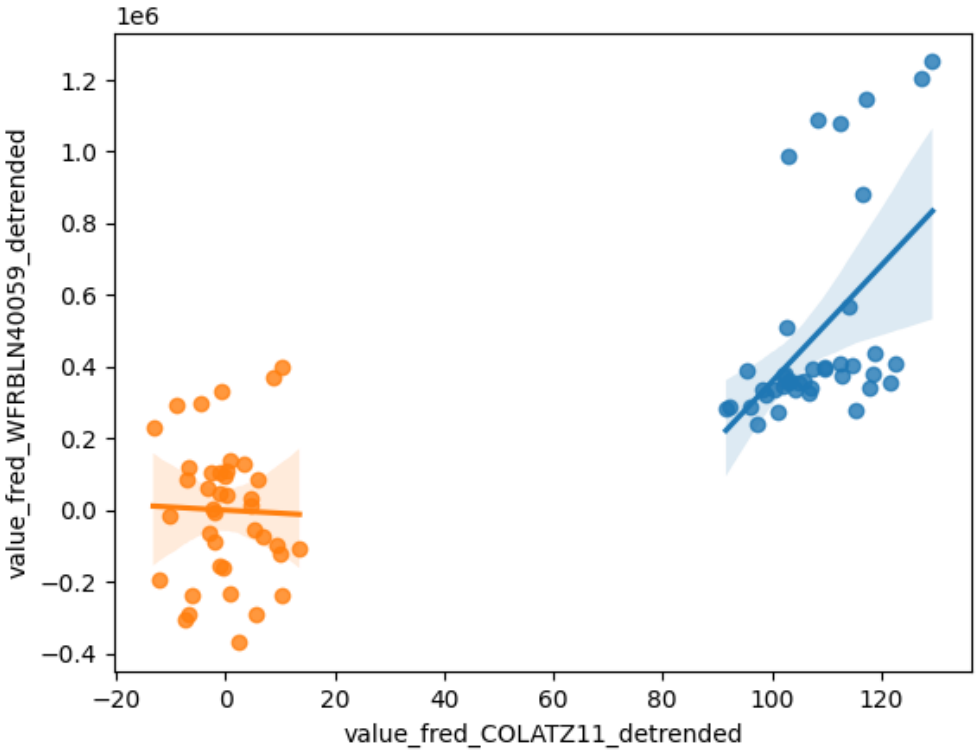


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-20